

ALONE IN THE DARK



Released: 1992
Developer: Infogrames
Publisher: Interplay Productions

The grandfather of all action-adventure games, *Alone in the Dark* is based loosely on the works of H.P. Lovecraft. Like the source of inspiration, the game's plot can leave you senseless at times and perpetually hanging in mystery. It was the first game to involve the player in an immersive and cinematic gaming experience. Stark camera angles and 3D graphics (a rarity then) heightened moments of suspense within the cursed 'roach-motel' like mansion of Decerto—you can check out anytime you like, but you can never leave!

GABRIEL KNIGHT II: THE BEAST WITHIN



Released: 1995
Publisher: Interplay Productions,
Developer: Infogrames

The Beast Within is a gala of ghoulish adventure that mesmerises and thrills through visceral explosions that span six CDs. The game sets off with an investigation into a possible werewolf sighting and uses live action sequences against backdrops shot in Germany—filmed against a blue screen and then seamlessly combined with over 1,300 photographed settings. An interestingly executed story threads historical facts with fictional musings to form a weave rich in intrigue, horror and mystery.

PHANTASMAGORIA

If a reported budget of \$4,000,000 does not put fear into your soul, then maybe a morbid and ghastly storyline will. Created by the mother of adventure games, Roberta Williams (of *King's Quest* fame), *Phantasmagoria* is an achievement in that it comes the closest to delivering a cinematic experience. Victoria Morsell stars as Adrienne Delaney, the protagonist of the game and David Homb as Don Gordon, her loving, albeit homicidal husband. They were blue-screened and digital background footage was later added. Created when an in-game cutscene was all the rage, this game effectively uses the said tool to bump an ordinary story into the twilight zone of a B-grade movie.



Released: 1995
Developer: Sierra Games
Publisher: Sierra Games

FRANKENSTEIN: THROUGH THE EYES OF THE MONSTER

So, you are wrongly accused of murdering your daughter. To make things worse, you are promptly hanged, undoubtedly a very gentlemanly thing to do. End of a bad day's living you think? Not if you happen to be buried in the vicinity of a spade-happy doctor. *Through the Eyes of the Monster* resurrects you, the player, as the beastly creation of one Dr Frankenstein, a part played quite hauntingly by the peerless Tim Curry. Browsing through his laboratory and the accompanied collection of oddities is twice as fun with Tim growling threateningly at you, complete with an eerie soundtrack.



Released: 1995
Developer: Amazing Media
Publisher: Interplay Productions

THE DARK EYE

With the works of Edgar Allen Poe forming a firm inspirational platform, *The Dark Eye* descends into the madness of one man's twisted world. The game presents an exploratory experience into the minds of the insane, murderers and their victims. Rendering the Floyd line of "all you touch and all you see, is all your life will ever be", the game draws upon animate and inanimate objects to throw you ever deeper into the realms of sinister designs and the resulting dismay. A troubling saga triggered by a sniff of paint thinner. The game uses stop-motion character animations, populates a multiple-story path with strong personalities and adds another layer of richness via the voice of legendary author William S. Burroughs.



Released: 1995
Developer: The Dreamer's Guild
Publisher: Expert Software